Logging errors and monitoring API performance are also essential practices for a production-ready system.

14.10 Exercise 42: Building a “Hello World” REST API in Laravel 12

14.10.1 Description

In this hands-on lab, we will build a **simple “Hello World” REST API** in **Laravel 12** that supports **GET, POST, PUT, and DELETE** requests. Each request will return a **message** and the **current server date and time**.

We will also **activate API support** in Laravel 12 before implementing our API.

14.10.2 Objectives

By the end of this lab, you will:

- Learn how to **enable API support in Laravel 12**
- Create a **REST API with GET, POST, PUT, and DELETE** endpoints
- Return a **structured response with a message and timestamp**
- Test the API using **Postman or cURL**

14.10.3 Prerequisites

Before starting, ensure you have:

- **PHP 8.2+**, Composer, and MySQL installed
- **Laravel 12 installed**
- **Postman or cURL** for API testing

> *This lab uses **PHP 8.4**, **Laravel 12** and **Visual Studio Code** as the primary editor.*

If you want to test Api with Postman, you can download it from Postman https://www.postman.com/downloads/.

14.10.4 Steps

Here are the steps to complete this lab: